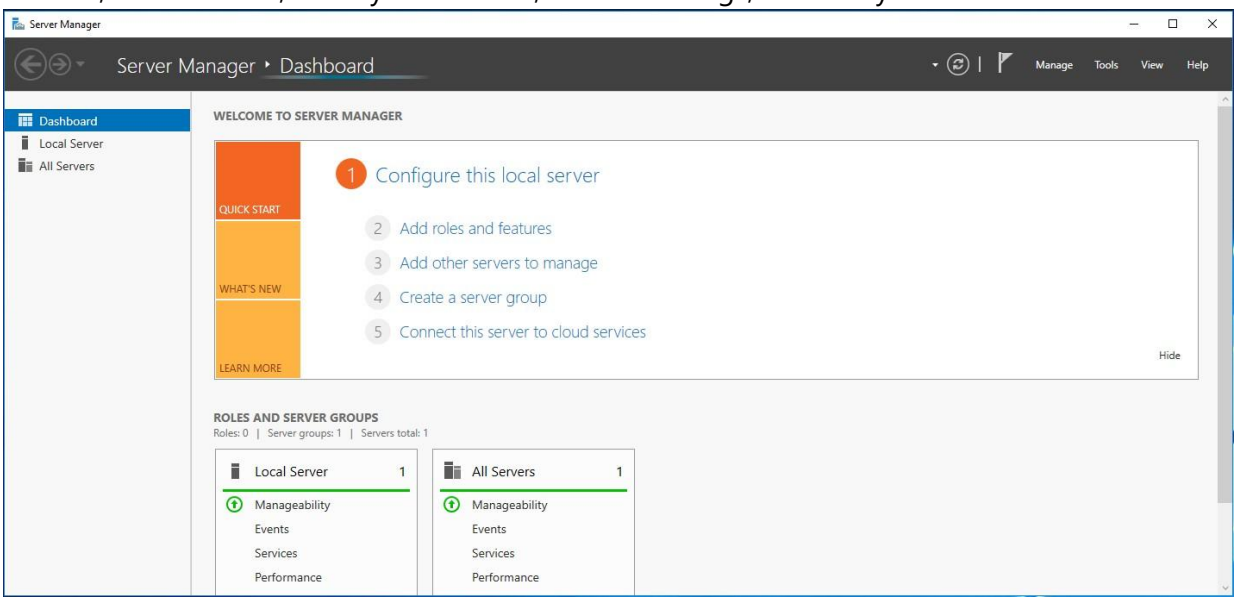
ITEC 235-940 System Administration

Active Directory Lab

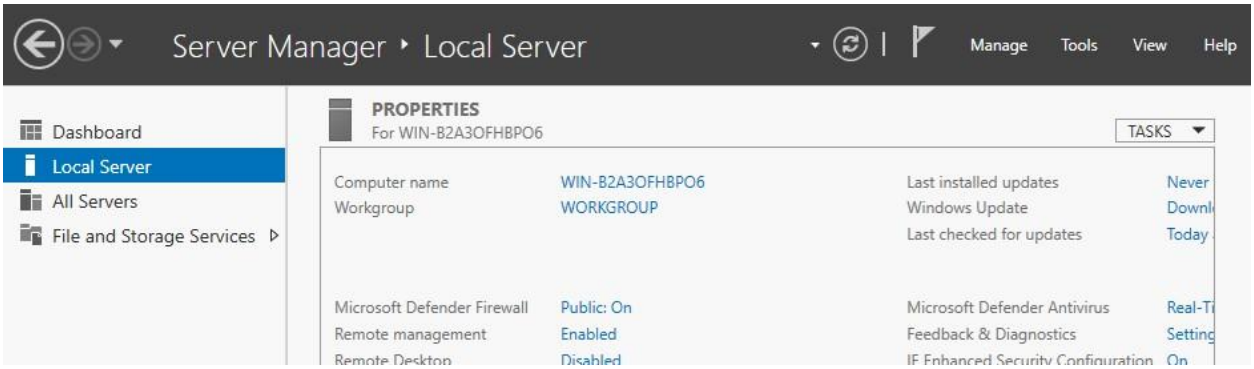
Server Manager

By default, Server Manager opens during startup on Windows Server 2022. Server Manager console provides a one-stop-shop for managing the local server as well as any remote server. From Server Manager, the network administrator can assign or change the role of a server, add features, start services, modify the firewall, view event logs, and many other tasks.



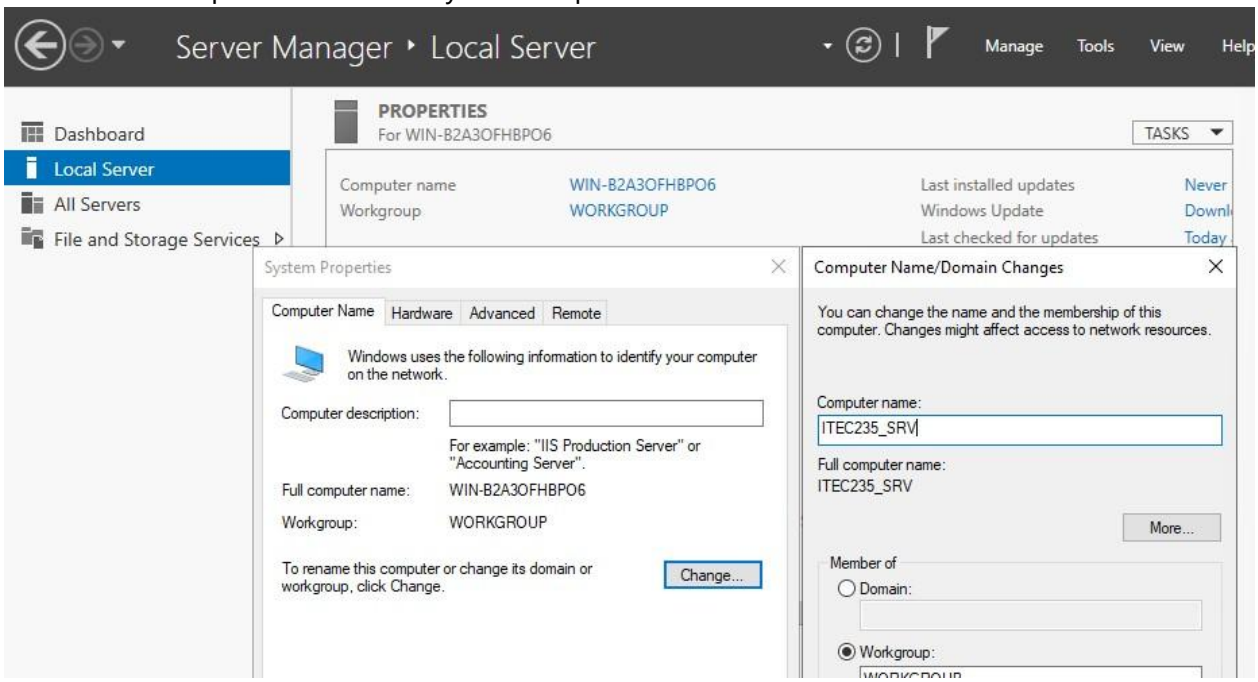
1. Start your Windows Server VM and login. Do not close the Server Manager console.

2. The navigation provided on the left side of Server Manager console provides easy access to the local server, remote server(s), server roles, and Server Manager Dashboard. Click "Local Server".



3. Click on the blue hypertext to the right of "Computer name". This causes the System Properties applet (sysdm.cpl) to open. Click on the "Change" button to rename your

server. Enter the server's name in the "Computer name" dialog box. I named my server ITEC235SRV, but you may choose any name you prefer. Click the "OK" buttons to close the Computer Name and System Properties windows.



4. Click the "Restart Now" button. Once the server reboot is complete, login and return to the Server Manager console.

5. Click "Local Server" in the navigation pane on the left. Notice that Computer Name now displays the name you entered in step 3.

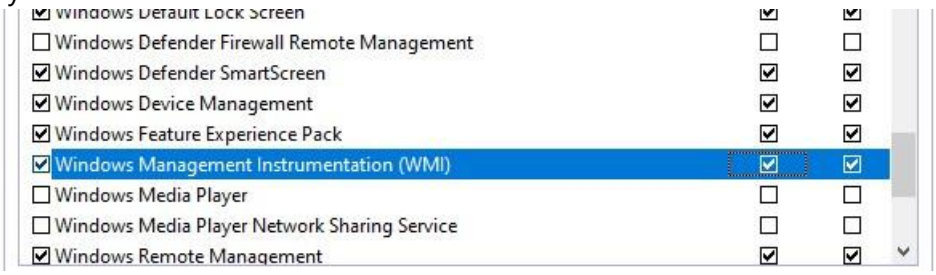


6. Click on the blue hypertext to the right of "Microsoft Defender Firewall". This causes the "Windows Security" configuration to open.

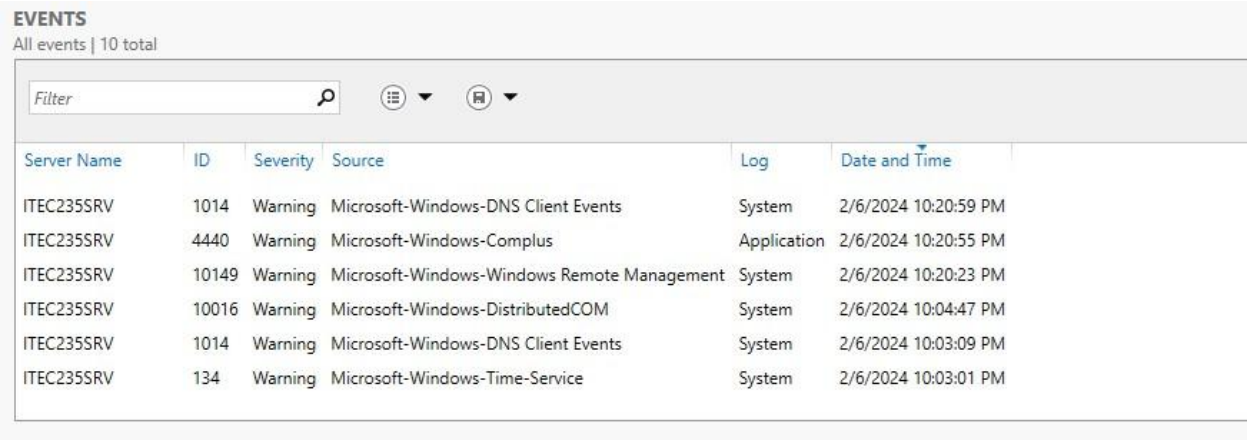


7. Click on the "Allow an app through firewall" hypertext. This opens the Windows Defender Firewall applet (firewall.cpl).

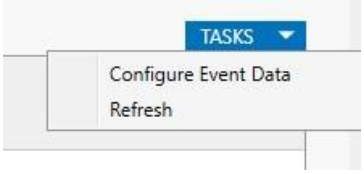
8. Scroll down and select the checkbox to the left of “Windows Management Instrumentation (WMI)”. Also select the “Private” checkbox to the right of Windows Management Instrumentation (WMI). Click the “OK” button and then close the Windows Security window.



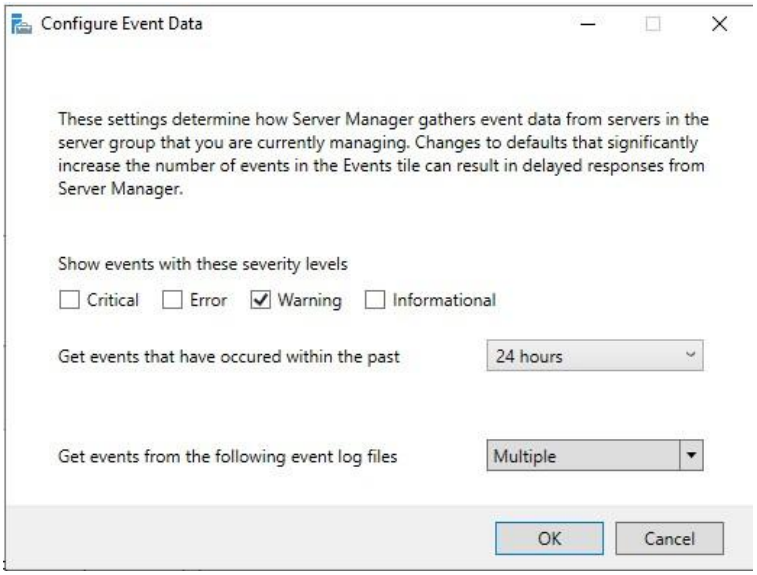
9. Returning to Server Manager > Local Server, scroll down (if necessary) to the “Events” pane. Review the events listed. See example below.



10. Click on the “Tasks” drop-down menu and select “Configure Event Data”.



11. Select “Warning”, remove any other check marks, and click the “OK” button. Notice that the list now shows only those events classified as “Warning” in the Events pane.



12. Scroll down to the "Services" pane. The Services pane allows you to check the status of a service, as well as start and/or stop a service. You can start/stop a service by right clicking on the service and choosing either stop or start from the quick access menu. Scroll through the list and view the various services. Do not start or stop a service at this time.

13. Scroll down to the "Best Practices Analyzer" pane. The Best Practices Analyzer will scan the server and compare the current configuration against a set of guidelines, considered to be ideal, for deficiencies. Once complete, BPA provides a list of recommended changes that the server manager can implement. To initiate a scan, click on the Tasks drop-down menu located in the upper right corner of the BPA pane and then select "Start BPA Scan".

14. Scroll down to the "Roles and Features" pane. This pane provides an overview of the currently installed roles and features. Roles and features can be added or removed by clicking on the Tasks drop-down menu in the upper right corner of the Roles and Features pane.

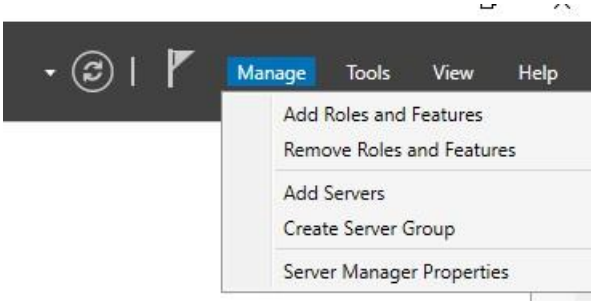
15. You are encouraged to spend some additional time with Server Manager to become familiar with its functionality.

Installation of Active Directory Services

1. Click on "Manage" in the upper right corner of the Server Manager window.

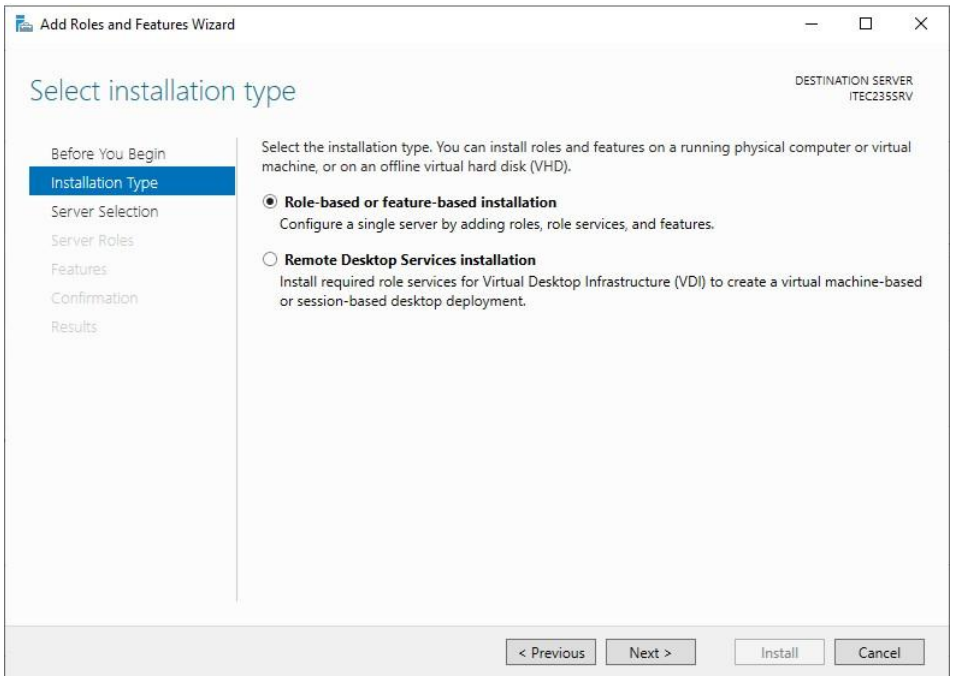


2. Select “Add Roles and Features” from the drop-down menu to open the “Add Roles and Features Wizard”.

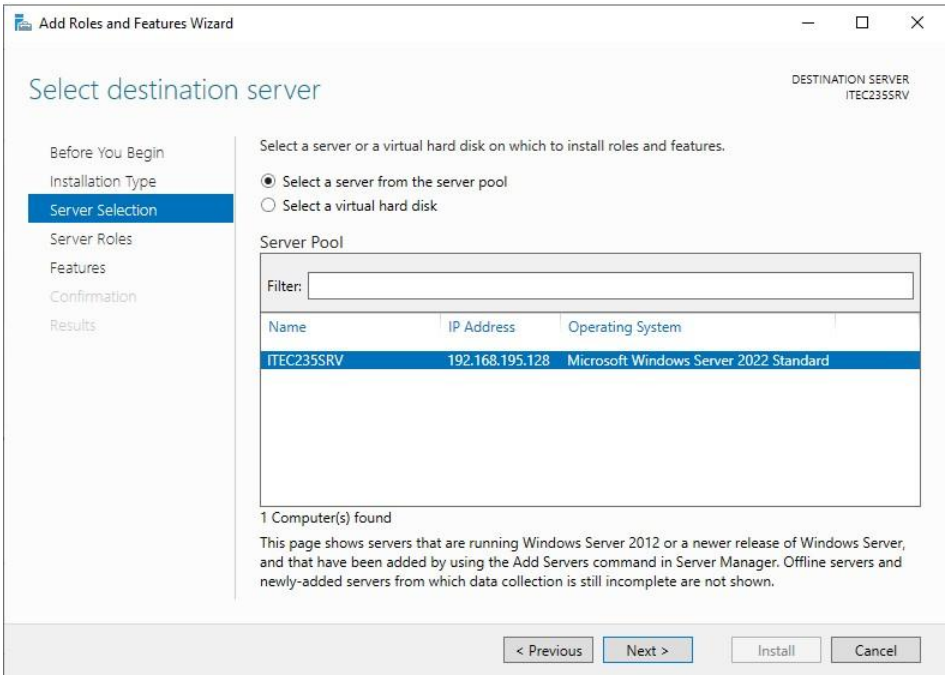


3. Click the “Next” button.

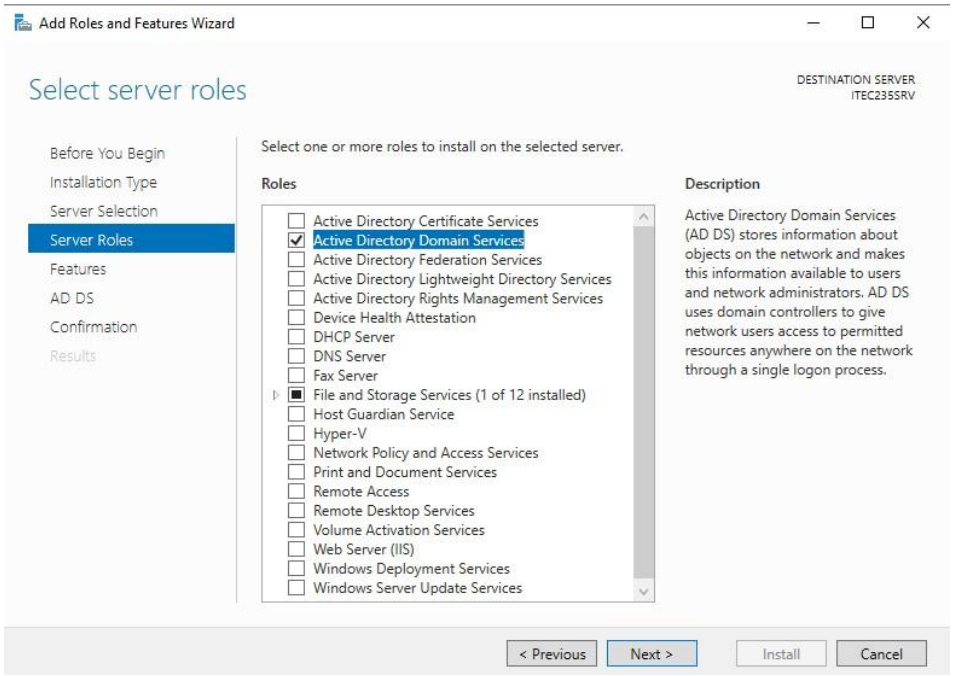
4. For Installation Type, select the radio button to the left of “Role-based or feature-based installation” and click the “Next” button.



5. For Server Selection, make certain your server is selected in the “Server Pool” window and click the “Next” button.



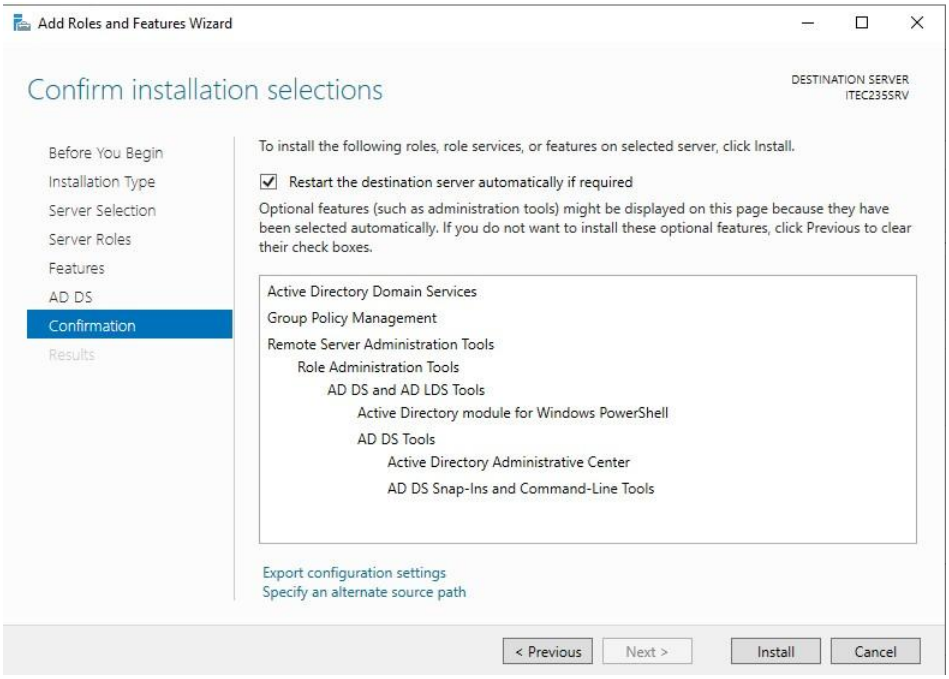
6. For Server Roles, select “Active Directory Domain Services”. Click the “Add Features” button from the pop-up window. Click on the “Next” button.



7. For Features, simply click the “Next" button.

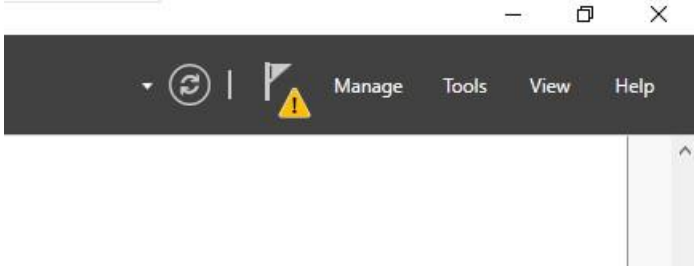
8. For AD DS, simply click the “Next” button.

9. For Confirmation, select the check box for “Restart the destination server automatically if required” and click the “Yes” button on the pop-up window. Click the “Install” button to begin installation.

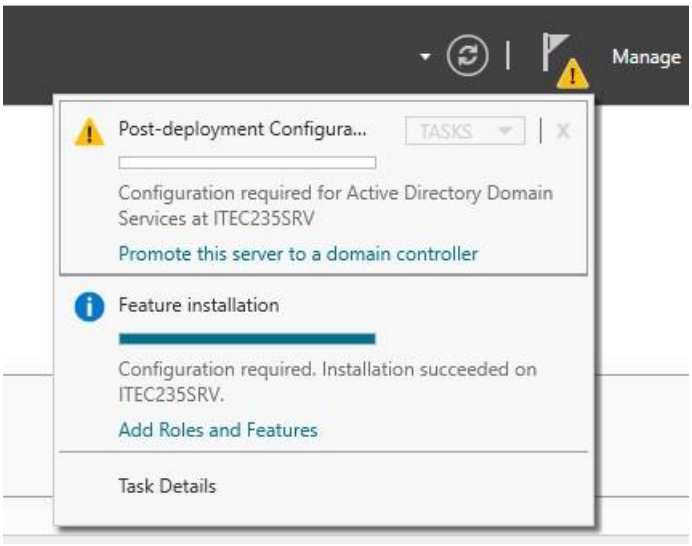


10. Once the installation has completed, click the “Close” button.

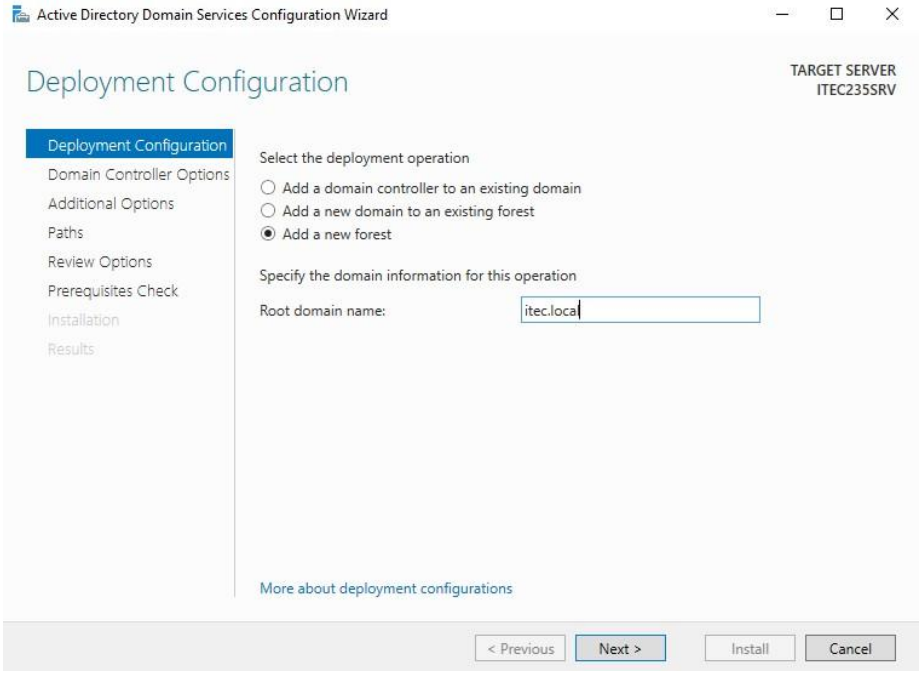
11. Notice the yellow triangle in the upper right corner of Server Manager.



12. Click the yellow triangle / flag and click on the “Promote this server to a domain controller” hypertext.



13. For Deployment Configuration, select the radio button to the left of “Add a new forest”. Enter a name ending in .local in the “Root domain name:” text box. I called my domain itec.local. Click the “Next” button.



14. Enter a Directory Services Restore Mode (DSRM) password in the “Password:” and “Confirm Password:” text boxes. Click the “Next” button.

15. For DNS Options, click the “Next” button. Ignore the warning that appears.

16. For Additional Options, wait for the NetBIOS text box to automatically populate and click the “Next” button.

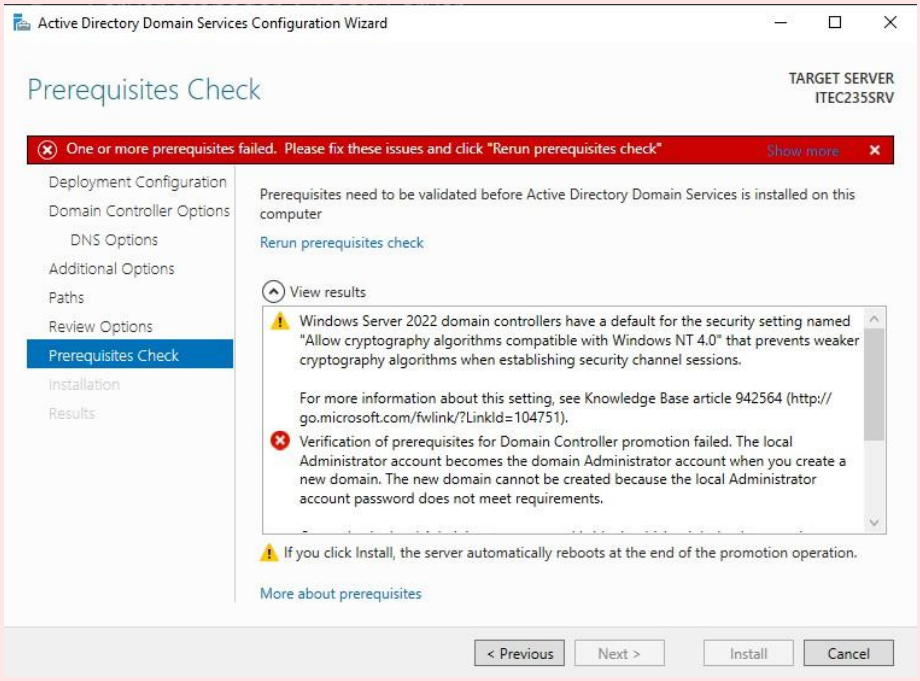
17. For Paths, leave the defaults and click the “Next" button.

18. For Review Options, click the “Next" button.

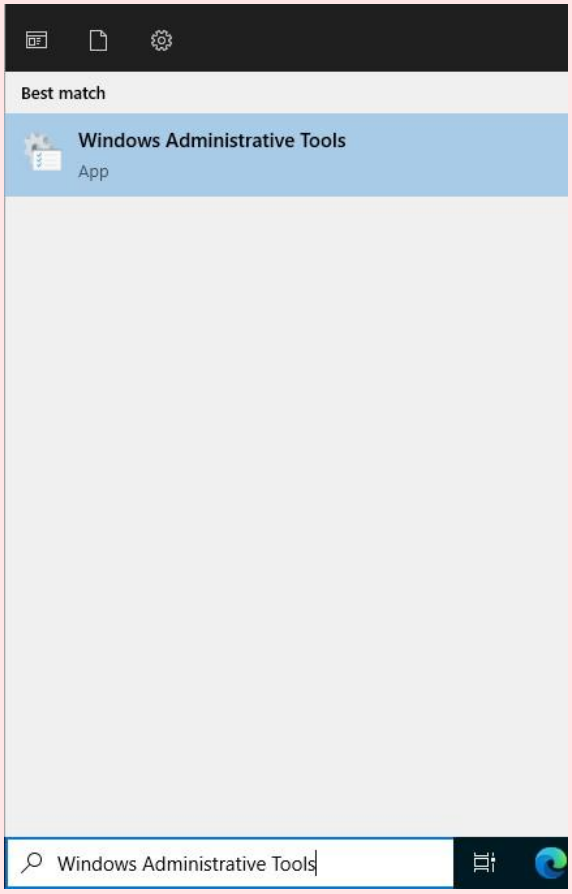
19. Click the “Install" button to begin the promotion. Continue to page 12.

ERROR Message

If you receive an error message regarding the Administrator Account password, complete the following steps.

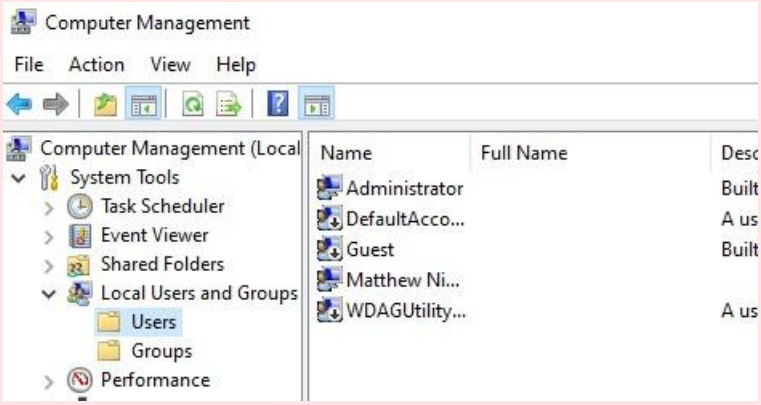


1. Type “Windows Administrative Tools” in the Search box located in the taskbar and press the “Enter” key.

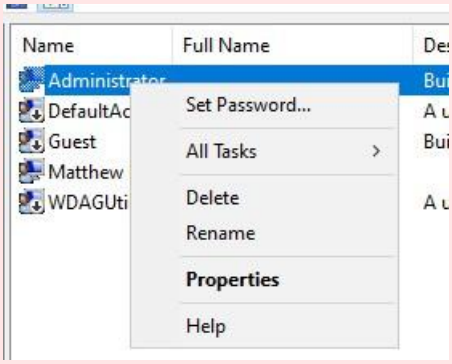


2. Double click “Computer Management”.

3. Click the drop-down arrow to the left of “Local Users and Groups”. Click on the “Users” folder.



4. Right click on “Administrator” and select “Set Password”.

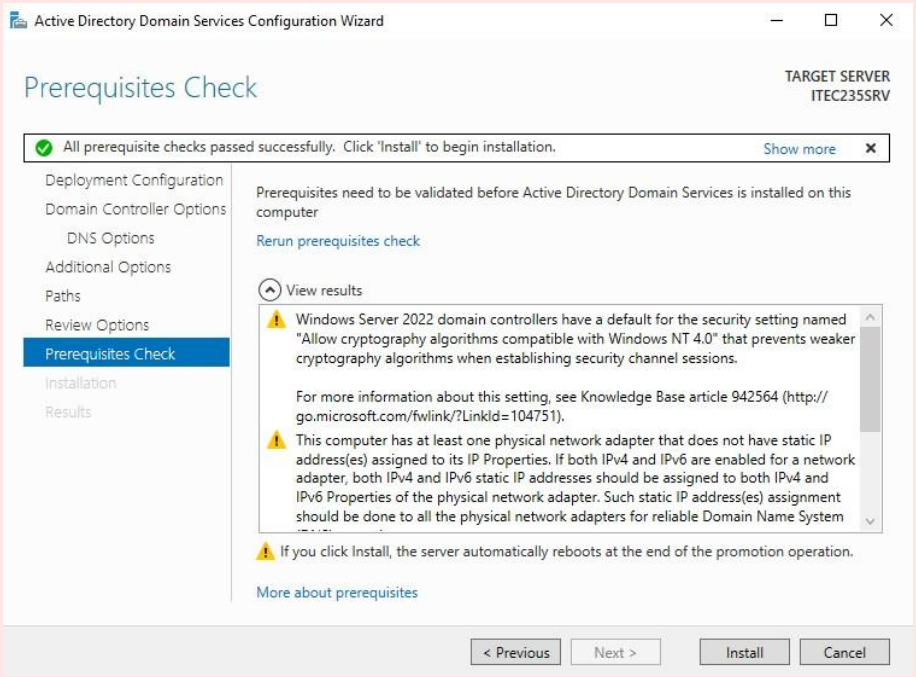


5. Click the “Proceed” button.

6. Enter a password that meets Windows complexity requirements. I like to use the password “ChangeMe1!” for lab accounts.

    a. Minimum of eight characters.
    b. At least one capital letter.
    c. At least one lowercase letter.
    d. At least one number.
    e. At least one special character.

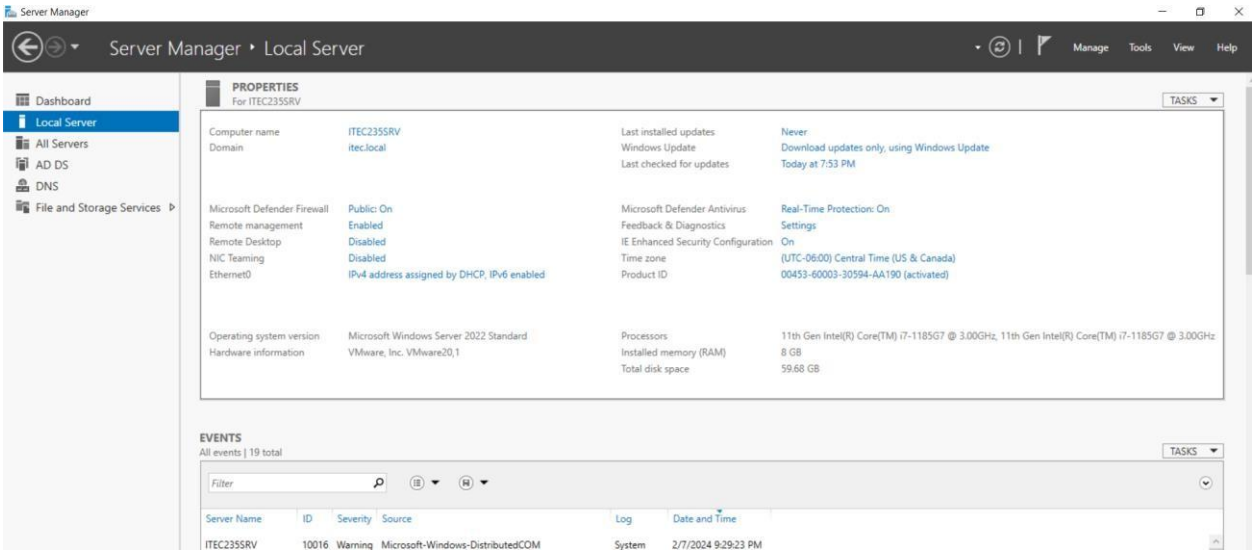
7. Return to the Active Directory Domain Services Configuration Wizard and click the “Previous” button followed by the “Next” button.



8. Click the “Install” button to begin promotion.

20. Once the Server reboots, notice that the username is now proceeded with the domain name. Enter your password to login.

21. Select “Local Server” in Server Manager and upload a screen capture showing your domain to the Active Directory Lab submission. See example below.



My Answer:

